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DJIA 50668.97 ▲ 24.69 0.05% NASDAQ 26917.47 ▲ 0.9% STOXX 600 625.11 ▼ 0.5% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 7/32, yield 4.454% OIL \$88.90 ▲ \$0.22 GOLD \$4,499.30 ▲ \$50.90 EURO \$1.1652 YEN 159.25

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **U.S. companies** are launching smaller and cheaper products, pitching value packages and, in some cases, reversing price increases to attract inflation-weary customers. **A1**
- ◆ **Anthropic** closed a funding round at a \$965 billion valuation, rocketing past OpenAI as the companies gear up for public listings this year. **B1**
- ◆ **The yield on the** 10-year Treasury note fell to 4.454% Thursday from 4.480% Wednesday, while stocks rose, lifting the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow by 0.6%, 0.9% and 0.05%, respectively. **B9**
- ◆ **Revised Commerce** Department data showed GDP grew 1.6% in the first quarter, slower than the 2% initially estimated. **A2**
- ◆ **Fertitta Entertainment** agreed to buy Caesars for about \$5.7 billion, assuming about \$11.9 billion of the casino company's debt. **B3**
- ◆ **Regulators** asked for more information to evaluate the proposed merger of the Union Pacific and Norfolk Southern railroads. **B2**
- ◆ **Tyson Foods** said Jeff Schomburger, a board member and former Procter & Gamble executive, will take over as the meatpacking company's next leader. **B3**
- ◆ **TD Bank** raised its dividend, joining other big Canadian banks following a strong underlying performance in the latest quarter. **B9**
- ◆ **A rocket** being tested by Jeff Bezos' space company, Blue Origin, exploded at its launch complex near Cape Canaveral, Fla., sending a giant ball of fire into the sky. **B2**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The U.S. and Iran** are within reach of an agreement to wind down the war, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said, but Trump hasn't signed off on it, and the White House wants a deal that satisfies several key conditions. **A6**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** ruled in favor of a Mississippi man on death row who argued that prosecutors used racist methods to keep Black people off the jury, a decision that will likely require a new trial for Terry Pitchford. **A3**
- ◆ **Michigan Gov. Gretchen Whitmer** said she won't seek the presidency in 2028, taking one of the Democratic Party's stars out of the running. **A4**
- ◆ **The CFTC** moved to undo a \$5 million settlement between the Winklevoss twins' Gemini cryptocurrency exchange and Biden-era regulators. **A4**
- ◆ **Disney's ABC** complied with the FCC's order to file for early license renewals for its eight local broadcast stations, but called the demands unconstitutional. **A4**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** held talks about putting Trump's face on a newly created \$250 bill, though Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the idea would need Congressional approval. **A3**
- ◆ **Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney** was in New York City to woo American investors, acknowledging that his push for less reliance on the U.S. would be a yearslong project. **A7**
- ◆ **Israel's attorney general** said an adviser to the prime minister will face criminal prosecution for leaking secret information to a German newspaper. **A6**

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Tennis's No. 1 Player Wilts in Heat of French Open



TIBAUT CAMUS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

ELIMINATED: Top-ranked Jannik Sinner, who had been the favorite to win the French Open, lost Thursday amid sweltering heat that visibly weakened him. The Italian star was upset in the second round by Argentina's Juan Manuel Cerundolo. **A12**

Shadowy Network of Tankers Keeps Oil From Iran Flowing

Defying sanctions, they meet off Malaysia to funnel illicit crude to China

By JON EMONT
AND REBECCA FENG

EASTERN OUTER PORT LIMITS—In this nautical no-man's-land 45 miles off the coast of Malaysia, tankers laden with sanctioned Iranian oil sit low in the water, waiting to offload their cargo to vessels bound for Chinese refineries.

They lower tarps over the names on their hulls and use

black paint to conceal identity numbers. They're here to carry out an elaborate deception: offshore trysts known as ship-to-ship transfers, in which one vessel offloads sanctioned oil onto another to help obscure the oil's origins before it is sent on to Iran's biggest customer.

These clandestine oil transfers reveal a key strength of the Iranian regime and a major reason why it has been able to hold firm for so long against American pressure: Iran can still sell its oil. In negotiations, the U.S. has so far resisted lifting oil sanctions against Iran. But the regime's workaround is still bringing in

crucial hard currency.

The Wall Street Journal recently observed this up close. On a May 8 visit by boat, Wall Street Journal reporters watched as the Catalina 7, an aging vessel sanctioned by the U.S. for carrying Iranian crude, transferred oil through a thick hose with a ship whose name was painted over.

The ships had lowered giant fenders between them to prevent the Catalina 7 from crushing the smaller ship as they rolled in the waves. Workers in orange vests and hard hats scurried around the Catalina 7's deck during the transfer.

Old and rusting tankers like

these form what maritime experts call the "shadow fleet," a roving armada of hundreds of vessels that ferry oil for sanctioned regimes, including Iran and Russia. Iran relies on such tankers for nearly all of its oil exports.

The ships, sometimes uninsured, have hidden owners and sail under "flags of convenience" from countries that pay little scrutiny to what the vessels are doing. At sea, the ships use deceptive practices such as turning off their tracking devices to make it

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◆ **U.S., Iran** have 'makings of a deal,' Bessent says..... **A6**

Real-Estate Agents Quit As Housing Market Slouches

By NICOLE FRIEDMAN

Kim Taylor bet her career on the housing market.

In mid-2023, the real-estate agent launched her own brokerage with her husband, Gordon Taylor. The market in the Fort Worth, Texas, area had cooled from its pandemic-era frenzy, but business was good. Taylor started out with a team of seven agents and quickly brought six more onboard.

By 2024, high mortgage rates and prices were weighing on demand, and homes sat on the market. Most of Taylor's agents had to find other part-time or full-time jobs to stay afloat. Her husband took a job last year working for a school district.

"We just became a bleeding artery," said Taylor, who started working in real estate in 2015. "The last 11 months have been the hardest of my career." She closed the brokerage this spring and joined another firm.

The slowest housing market in decades is stretching into its fourth year, and even real-estate agents who made it this far are reaching a breaking point. Most agents are independent contractors and get paid when a deal

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◆ **Mortgage rates** hit highest level since August..... **A2**

INSIDE



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BUSINESS & FINANCE
CBS News makes sweeping changes to '60 Minutes,' replacing program's top boss. **B1**



MANSION
Proposed California tax boosts Nevada side of the Lake Tahoe real-estate market. **M1**

A Contest to Become Commodore Has Torn This Yacht Club Apart

* * *

The Sausalito club refused to elevate Marisa McArthur. She started a war.

By PAMELA PAUL

SAUSALITO, Calif.—Only after she was told she wouldn't be commodore of the Sausalito Yacht Club did Marisa McArthur realize how badly she wanted it.

McArthur had joined the club in 2018 for the social life and was surprised by how much she enjoyed becoming membership chair in 2020. Three years later she gladly accepted her nomination as rear commodore. From there it should

have been a clear shot to the top. According to yacht club tradition, advancing from rear vice to commodore is an uncontested progression.

But when McArthur came before the nominating committee in March 2025 for her final promotion, the 50-year-old was told advancement was a no go.

"We've heard people don't like you," she recalled them saying.

What followed was a contentious election campaign, McArthur's expulsion, her husband's and mother's suspension. *Please turn to page A9*



Naval warfare

China's New Export: Lots of Its Factories

By HANNAH MIAO
AND STEPHEN WILMOT

"Made in China" is becoming "made by China"—all over the world.

Faced with higher Western tariffs and weak demand at home, many Chinese factories are moving abroad, making everything from appliances to automobiles everywhere from North and South America to Eastern Europe.

More Chinese companies could be coming to the U.S., after President Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jin-

ping reached a deal in Beijing this month to establish a bilateral "board of investment."

Yet many leaders, especially in the U.S. and Europe, worry the Chinese businesses are bringing China's brutal competition with them, potentially crushing local incumbents and curbing salaries.

Gotion, a Chinese battery maker, planned to build a \$2.4 billion plant in Michigan, but the project is at a standstill after years of local opposition over the company's Chinese roots. Another Chinese battery

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Online Sleuth Uncovered Google Prediction Trader

By ALEXANDER OSIPOVICH

Late last year, Haeju Jeong noticed that a mystery trader on Polymarket had just earned more than \$1 million with a series of uncannily accurate bets on the top Google search results of 2025. He shared his suspicions with the internet.

"He's a Google insider milking Polymarket for quick money," Jeong, a blockchain engineer, wrote on X. "It's one of the wildest things I've seen on the platform."

Now, the government has said he was right. In a criminal complaint this week, federal prosecutors alleged that Michele Spagnuolo, a longtime software engineer at Google, used his access to internal

company data to place the lucrative bets, using a Polymarket account called "AlphaRaccoon." It was the same account that Jeong identified in his Dec. 4 tweet, which went viral and drew more than 6 million views. It was the latest case of amateur sleuths identifying suspicious activity on Polymarket in nearly real time, before law enforcement gets involved.

Spagnuolo, an Italian citizen who was charged with fraud and money laundering, didn't respond to a request for comment. His prosecution follows the April arrest of Gannon Ken Van Dyke, a U.S. special-forces soldier accused of using his role in the military

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